

Week 3 Installation Guide: Required Libraries and Tools

Install the tools we will use this week: Python packages (FastAPI stack) + Postman.

1) Confirm you have Python 3

Open **PowerShell** and run:

```
PowerShell
python --version
pip --version
```

If Python is not found on Windows, install it from python.org and **make sure you check**:

☒ “Add python.exe to PATH” during install.

2) Create a project folder (recommended)

Create a folder anywhere, for example `api-class`, then open Terminal/PowerShell inside it.

(Optional but strongly recommended) Create a virtual environment:

Windows (PowerShell)

```
PowerShell
python -m venv .venv
.\.venv\Scripts\Activate.ps1
```

You should now see `(.venv)` at the start of your Terminal line.

3) Install required Python packages

Run these commands in your activated environment.

Use `pip`:

```
PowerShell
pip install fastapi
pip install uvicorn
pip install sqlalchemy
pip install pymysql
pip install cryptography
pip install pydantic python-dotenv
```

Quick install option

If you prefer one command:

Terminal/shell

```
pip install fastapi uvicorn sqlalchemy pymysql cryptography pydantic python-dotenv
```

4) Install Postman

Install Postman from the official website:

- postman.com/downloads
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5) Quick test (make sure everything works)

Create a file named `main.py` in your project folder:

python

```
from fastapi import FastAPI

app = FastAPI()

@app.get("/")
def home():
    return {"status": "ok"}
```

Run the server:

PowerShell

```
uvicorn main:app --reload
```

Now open in your browser:

- <http://127.0.0.1:8000/>
- <http://127.0.0.1:8000/docs> (Swagger UI)

If `/docs` opens, you are ready for class 